TidyTuesday Week 46

Pranay Gundam

Wednesday 11th November, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the show where we blindfold a dartboard, throw it at the entire FRED database, and then act shocked when two completely unrelated numbers hold hands. This week our noble random-number generator served up three pairings, and I regret to inform you that one of them put up an R-squared so high I briefly had to sit down.

Monday's contestant was the blockbuster: "Rest of the World Debt Securities and Loans" versus "Per Capita Spending on Housing and Utilities in the Plains Region." The raw regression delivered an R-squared of 0.96, which in the land of spurious correlation is basically a marriage proposal. Ninety-six percent! You could practically hear the breathless press release writing itself: foreign debt levels EXPLAIN what people in Nebraska pay to heat their homes! Except, of course, both numbers have spent the last several decades doing the one thing every economic series loves to do – going up. So we detrended it, stripped out the shared "everything gets bigger over time" magic, and the R-squared face-planted from 0.96 down to a dignity-shredding 0.15. The relationship technically limped across the p-value finish line at 0.036, but let's be honest, that's the statistical equivalent of a participation trophy. A textbook trend mirage, and exactly the kind of thing this project exists to point and laugh at.

Tuesday and Wednesday, mercifully, declined to embarrass themselves with any pretense of significance. First we paired a discontinued loan-syndication percentage (sample size: approximately a long weekend) against the import price index for household appliances, which returned a p-value of 0.76 and an R-squared of 0.005 – a correlation so limp it could barely stand. Then, in the crossover episode nobody requested, we matched the World Pandemic Uncertainty Index for Myanmar against the San Francisco Tech Pulse. Did Myanmar's pandemic anxiety predict Silicon Valley's vibes? No. P-value of 0.13 raw, 0.18 detrended, both of which are statistics-speak for "please stop." I was really hoping for something there, if only for the headline.

As always, the mandatory disclaimer: these are randomly paired economic series with zero theoretical reason to be in the same spreadsheet together, and any relationship you see is almost certainly nonsense dressed up in a decimal point. Even this week's one flashy "hit" dissolved the instant we asked it to work for a living. Spurious correlation isn't the bug around here – it's the entire genre. Tune in next week, where I will once again be personally betrayed by an R-squared.

2 Date: 2026-11-09

Series ID: DODFFSWCMI
This series is titled Rest of the World; Debt Securities and Loans; Liability, Level and has a frequency of Quarterly, End of Period. The units are Millions of U.S. Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted Annual Rate.The observation start date is 1945-10-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01.The popularity of this series is 15.

Series ID: PLNSPCEPCHOUSUTL
This series is titled Per Capita Personal Consumption Expenditures: Services: Housing and Utilities for Plains BEA Region and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1997-01-01 and the observation end date is 2025-01-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PLNSPCEPCHOUSUTL	**R-squared:**	0.961
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.959
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	660.0
Date:	Mon, 09 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	1.64e-20
Time:	21:41:25	**Log-Likelihood:**	-207.55
No. Observations:	29	**AIC:**	419.1
Df Residuals:	27	**BIC:**	421.8
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	3193.5604	115.903	27.554	0.000	2955.747	3431.374
value_fred_DODFFSWCMI	0.0008	3.03e-05	25.690	0.000	0.001	0.001

Omnibus:	0.836	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.483
Prob(Omnibus):	0.658	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	0.750
Skew:	0.053	**Prob(JB):**	0.687
Kurtosis:	2.219	**Cond. No.**	7.43e+06

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

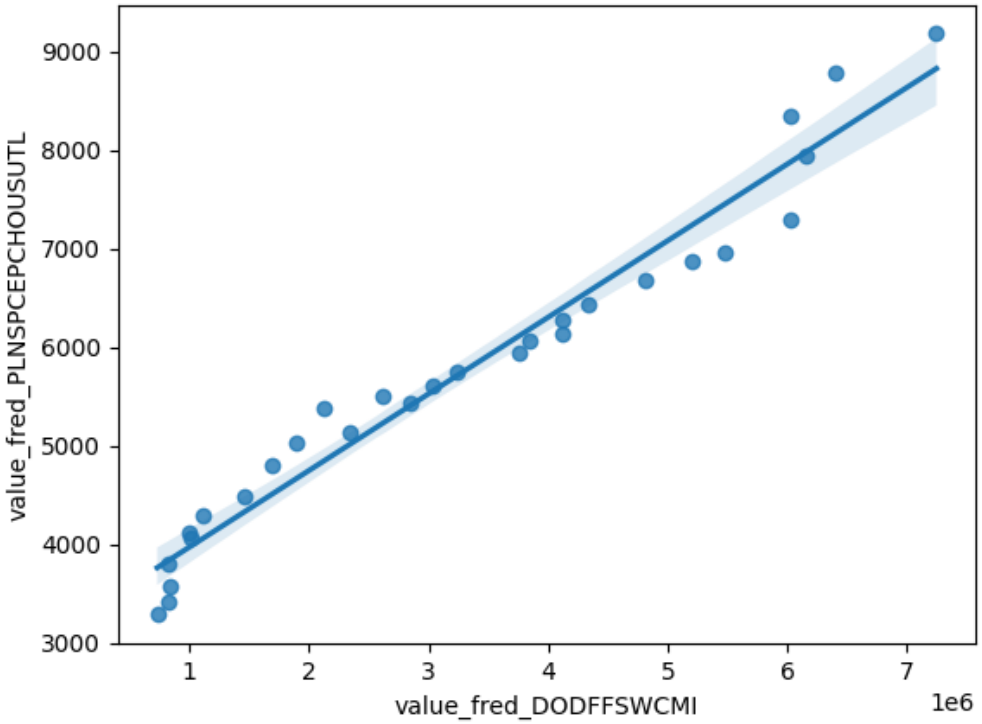


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-11-09

[2] The condition number is large, 7.43e+06. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PLNSPCEPCHOUSUTL_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.152
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.121
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	4.857
Date:	Mon, 09 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.0363
Time:	21:41:25	**Log-Likelihood:**	-204.23
No. Observations:	29	**AIC:**	412.5
Df Residuals:	27	**BIC:**	415.2
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-2.367e-12	53.276	-4.44e-14	1.000	-109.314	109.314
value_fred_DODFFSWCMI_detrended	0.0004	0.000	2.204	0.036	2.46e-05	0.001

Omnibus:	1.083	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.261
Prob(Omnibus):	0.582	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	0.897
Skew:	0.409	**Prob(JB):**	0.638
Kurtosis:	2.726	**Cond. No.**	3.29e+05

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 3.29e+05. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

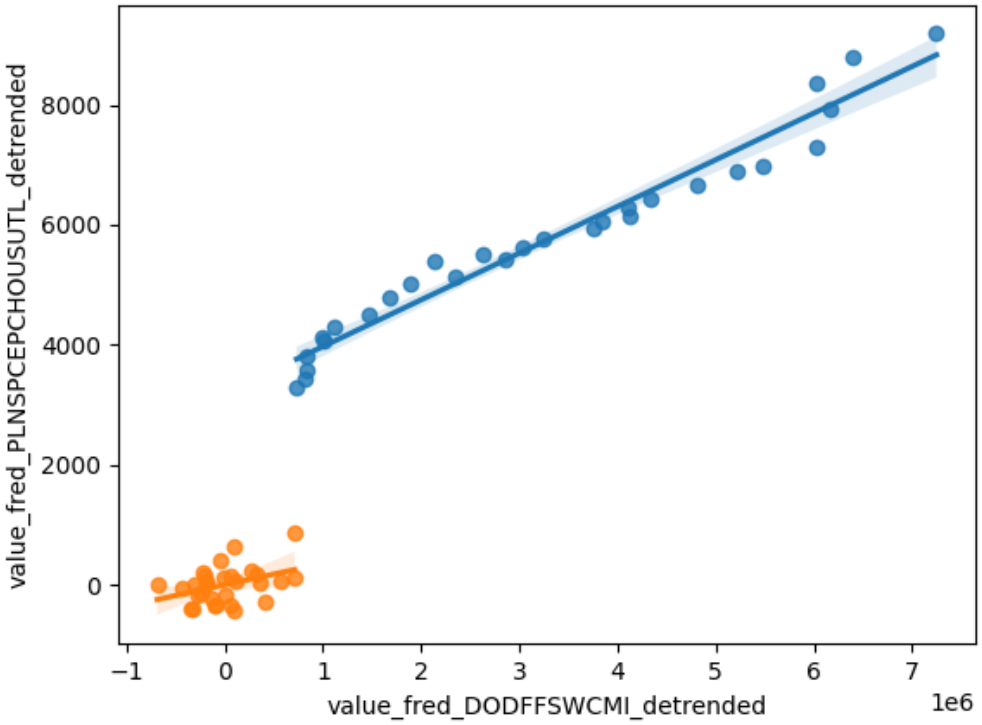


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-11-09

3 Date: 2026-11-10

Series ID: EF1T99XSLNQ
This series is titled Percent of Value of Loans Made Under Participation or Syndication by Size of Loan: ($ Thousands) $10 to $99, Large Domestic Banks (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly, 2nd Month's 1st Full Week. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2012-07-01 and the observation end date is 2017-04-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: IR41030
This series is titled Import Price Index (End Use): Household Appliances and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index 2000=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1984-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-09-01.The popularity of this series is 3.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IR41030	**R-squared:**	0.005
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.050
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.09834
Date:	Tue, 10 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.757
Time:	18:58:16	**Log-Likelihood:**	-48.115
No. Observations:	20	**AIC:**	100.2
Df Residuals:	18	**BIC:**	102.2
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	110.6895	1.199	92.314	0.000	108.170	113.209
value_fred_EF1T99XSLNQ	-0.0286	0.091	-0.314	0.757	-0.221	0.163

Omnibus:	1.232	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.197
Prob(Omnibus):	0.540	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	1.035
Skew:	-0.357	**Prob(JB):**	0.596
Kurtosis:	2.145	**Cond. No.**	25.0

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

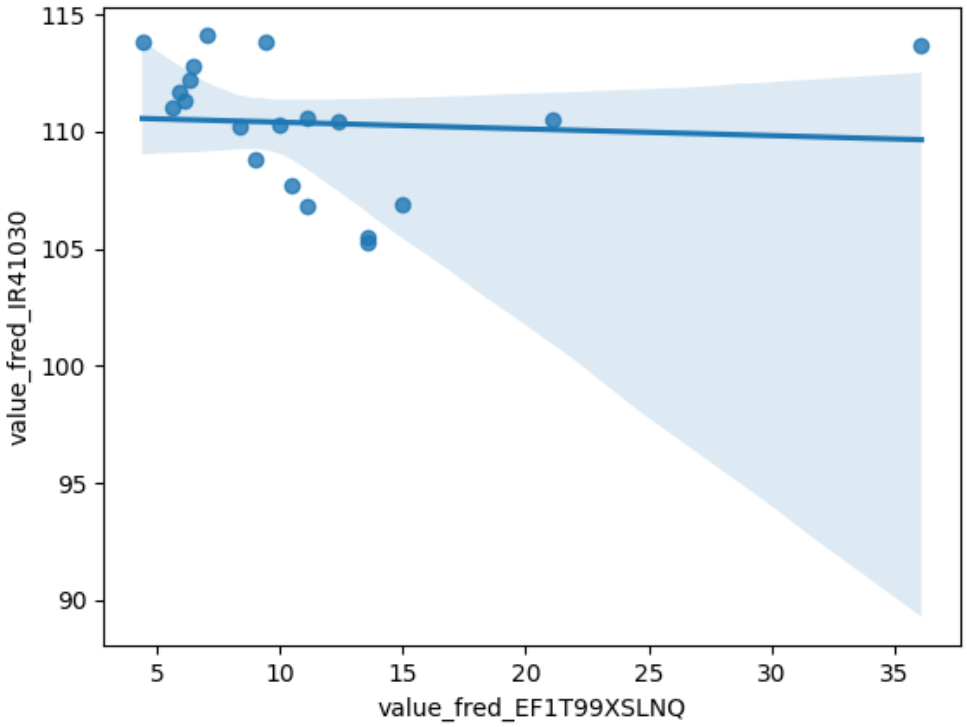


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-11-10

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IR41030_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.011
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.044
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.1915
Date:	Tue, 10 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.667
Time:	18:58:16	**Log-Likelihood:**	-31.490
No. Observations:	20	**AIC:**	66.98
Df Residuals:	18	**BIC:**	68.97
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	1.939e-12	0.275	7.04e-12	1.000	-0.579	0.579
value_fred_EF1T99XSLNQ_detrended	0.0176	0.040	0.438	0.667	-0.067	0.102

Omnibus:	0.487	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.960
Prob(Omnibus):	0.784	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	0.071
Skew:	0.145	**Prob(JB):**	0.965
Kurtosis:	3.008	**Cond. No.**	6.86

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

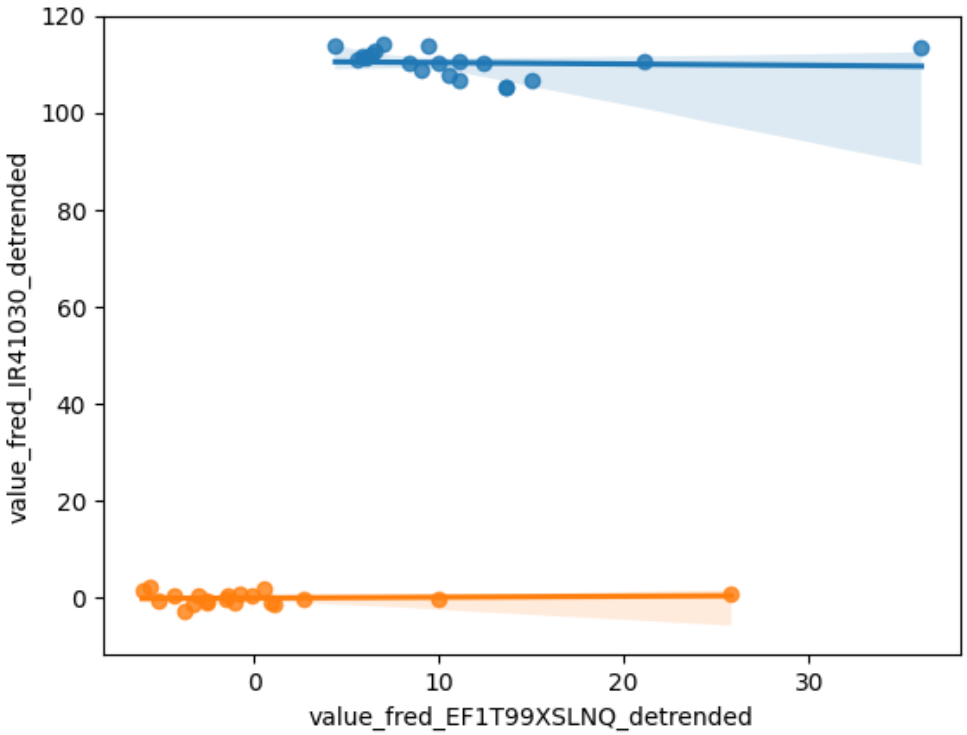


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-11-10

4 Date: 2026-11-11

Series ID: WUPIMMR

This series is titled World Pandemic Uncertainty Index for Myanmar and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1996-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: SFTPINDM114SFRBSF

This series is titled San Francisco Tech Pulse (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Jan 2000=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1971-04-01 and the observation end date is 2020-03-01.The popularity of this series is 9.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SFTPINDM114SFRBSF	**R-squared:**	0.024
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.013
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	2.309
Date:	Wed, 11 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.132
Time:	18:56:01	**Log-Likelihood:**	-381.14
No. Observations:	97	**AIC:**	766.3
Df Residuals:	95	**BIC:**	771.4
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	83.0755	1.269	65.444	0.000	80.555	85.596
value_fred_WUPIMMR	-0.2581	0.170	-1.519	0.132	-0.595	0.079

Omnibus:	4.185	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.129
Prob(Omnibus):	0.123	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	3.548
Skew:	0.445	**Prob(JB):**	0.170
Kurtosis:	3.296	**Cond. No.**	7.51

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

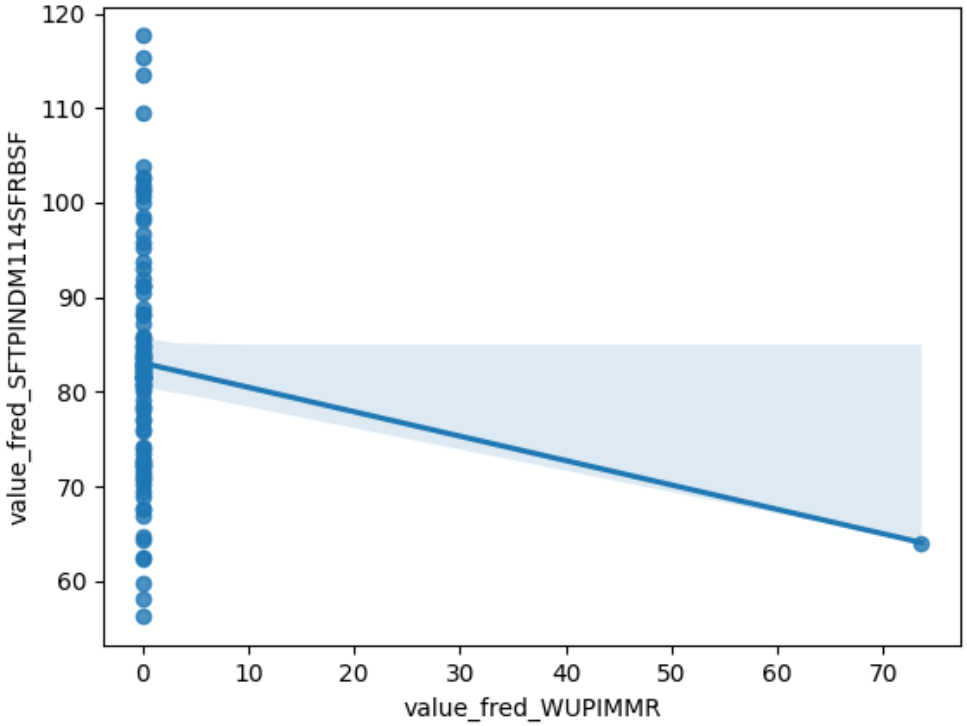


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-11-11

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SFTPINDM114SFRBSF_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.019
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.009
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	1.861
Date:	Wed, 11 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.176
Time:	18:56:01	**Log-Likelihood:**	-374.38
No. Observations:	97	**AIC:**	752.8
Df Residuals:	95	**BIC:**	757.9
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	7.54e-13	1.178	6.4e-13	1.000	-2.338	2.338
value_fred_WUPIMMR_detrended	-0.2166	0.159	-1.364	0.176	-0.532	0.099

Omnibus:	26.198	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.131
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	39.153
Skew:	1.224	**Prob(JB):**	3.15e-09
Kurtosis:	4.922	**Cond. No.**	7.42

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

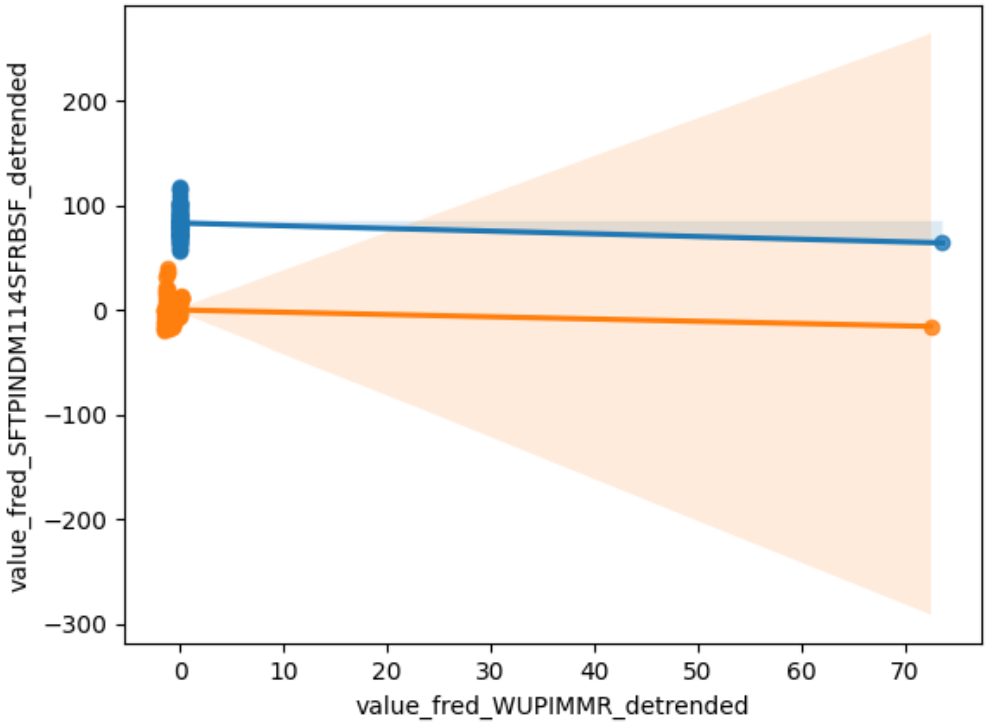


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-11-11